Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

LEARN MORE

Change of Status to F-1

Students currently in the United States on certain nonimmigrant visa types who wish to study at USC as F-1 students have two options for obtaining F-1 status. Before beginning this process, students must meet with an OIS advisor to review eligibility and next steps.

Jump to a Section

Option 1: Submit COS Application to USCIS

This option requires admitted/active students to file an Application to Extend/Change Nonimmigrant Status (Form I-539) with USCIS while physica for a Change of Status (COS) can be found on the USCIS w ximately four and a half months, depending on the se e is no fee for the COS I-20 itself, students are responsible f 1 fee.

Receiving a COS I-20 from USC does not char orm I-539 USCIS, submit all supporting document d.

Need help?

Hi there! I'm Tommy, and I am here to answer your questions. What can I help with?

Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

LEARN MORE

USC

Office of International Services

Option 2: Travel and Reenter the United States in F-1 Student Status

This option requires students to depart the United States, apply for an F-1 visa at the U.S. embassy or consulate and reenter with their USC Form I-20 and F-1 visa in time for the first day of classes.

Students who choose this option will:

1. Depart the United States with an "Initial Attendance" Form I-20.
2. Pay the SEVIS I-901 fee.
3. Apply for an F-1 visa at a U.S. embassy or consulate abroad. Canadian citizens are exempt from this requirement.
4. Reenter the United States in F-1 status by the program start date printed on their Form I-20.
5. Complete Immigration Status Verification in Trojan International.

This option automatically changes the stude . The length of this process varies depending on the stud the processing time for the F-1 visa at the U.S. er reenter the United States and successfully complete Imm r for classes and receive paid assistantships or on-campu

Need help?

Hi there! I'm Tommy, and I am here to answer your questions. What can I help with?

Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

LEARN MORE

USC

Office of International Services

Maintaining Status | Students

Related Pages

Immigration Status Verification

Back to Top

USC University of Southern California

Address:
Royal Street Structure, Suite 101
649 West 34th St.
Los Angeles, CA 90089-1626

Need help?



Hi there! I'm Tommy, and I am here to answer your questions. What can I help with?

Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

LEARN MORE

USC

Office of International Services

Maintaining Status | Students

Privacy Notice

Notice of Non-Discrimination

Digital Accessibility

Smoke-Free Policy

Copyright © 2026 University of Southern California

Need help?



Hi there! I'm Tommy, and I am here to answer your questions. What can I help with?